



SUKKOT

COOL FACTS #1

SUKKOT HAS THREE NAMES

How many names do you have? One, two or maybe more. We've all got the name we were given at birth and then some other names that we collect along the way.

Did you know that Sukkot has more than just one name? It's got three!! What are they?

NAME #1

SUKKOT, OF COURSE!

SUKKOT is the plural version of the word SUKKA. It's the holiday on which we leave the comfort of our homes, and spend as much time as possible in a temporary structure called a Sukkah. On this holiday we remember the protection that Hashem provided for the Jews when they were in the desert. Some Rabbis say that He actually built huts for the Jews while others say that He protected them with holy clouds. Either way, the Jews didn't have to suffer the extreme heat and other discomforts of living in a desert for 40 years. Phew!!

NAME #2:

CHAG HA-ASIF

CHAG means festival. HA-ASIF means gathering of crops. Together that makes... "The festival of crop gathering." In the olden days, many Jews were farmers. Sukkot was the time of year that they would gather all the crops that had grown in the summer and store them away for the winter ahead. It is a perfect time to thank Hashem for all the blessings that He gives us.

NAME #3:

ZMAN SIMCHATEINU

ZMAN means time or period. SIMCHATEINU means our rejoicing. Together that makes... "The period of our rejoicing." Coming after the serious days of Rosh Hashana and Yom Kippur, Sukkot is a time when we rejoice about being Jewish.





SUKKOT

COOL FACTS #2



HOW DO YOU BUILD A SUKKAH?

Did you know that the word “kosher” is not only for food? There are kosher Sukkahs and non-kosher Sukkahs. **What makes a Sukkah kosher?**



סוכה

Look carefully at word “SUKKAH” in Hebrew. It is made up of four letters. ס Samech, כ Kaf, and ה Hay. Each has a different number of sides - 4, 3 and 2 1/2. Isn't it cool that that's what makes a kosher Sukkah? A Sukkah has got to have either 2 1/2, 3 or 4 walls.

The walls of a Sukkah can be made of any material - as long as it is stable. Wood, plastic, fabric are the typical materials used. We've even used lego, plastic bottles and beads!!



The roof of the Sukkah must be made of Schach. Schach is something that grew directly from the ground and has been cut. Examples of kosher schach are: Branches, Palm Leaves, Bamboos, etc. Today, many people use made mats made out of bamboo sticks.

A Sukkah must stand directly under the sky. There can be nothing in between. Building a Sukkah on patio with a roof or under a tree is not acceptable. Also the Schach must provide more shade than sun.



We try to do as many things as possible in the Sukkah like eating, drinking, reading, playing games, etc. Some people even sleep in the Sukkah!!





SUKKOT

COOL FACTS #3

THE FOUR KINDS

The second mitzvah on the holiday of Sukkot is to make a bracha and shake the "four kinds." Four kinds of what? Four kinds of plants!! What are they?

1.



The **ETROG** looks like a large, bumpy lemon but it isn't a lemon at all! It is a citron fruit that grows in very special climates. It has a very beautiful smell and a very strong taste.

2.



The **LULAV** is a tall, thin branch from a date palm tree. It is cut from the tree before its branches spread open.

3.



The **HADAS** is a myrtle branch. It has many small leaves attached to a straight branch. These leaves have a beautiful smell. We use three of these in the "Lulav Set."

4.



The **ARAVA** is a willow branch. These are large, floppy leaves attached to a branch. The arava branch does not have any smell at all. We use two of these in the "Lulav Set."

DID YOU KNOW?

Each of the "Four Kinds" is shaped like a different part of our body.

Etrog = Heart. Lulav = Spine. Hadas = Eyes. Arava = Lips.

Just like we take all four kinds and shake them together, we can use ALL the parts our bodies for different mitzvot. Can you think of which Mitzvot we do with each?





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COOL FACTS #4



The holiday of Sukkot lasts for **7 DAYS**. Since its a "festival of rejoicing" that's great news! In Israel the first day is Chag while out of the Israel the first two days are Chag. The rest of the days are Chol Hamoed - Intermediate days.



There are two special Mitzvot we do on Sukkot:

1. Sitting in the Sukkah.
2. Shaking the Four Kinds.

There are special Brachot that we say when we do each of these Mitzvot.



The Mitzvah of sitting in Sukkah is the **ONLY** mitzvah we have that we do with our **ENTIRE** body.



Although the Jews began their journey in the desert in the spring time, this festival is celebrated in the fall. Do you know why? In many parts of the world, the weather is not very pleasant during this time of year. By celebrating Sukkot in the fall, we are showing that we are not eating there because its pleasant and provides shade from the sun. We sit in the Sukkah because it is a Mitzvah.

